

s a log of past activities (use Activity Based Logging Guide)

#### SA Next Steps Date

- Date of first planned activity in SA Next Steps
- Enables daily to-do list extraction
- Indicates when SA Next Steps needs updating

#### SA Next Steps History

- Auto-updates with SA Next Steps changes
- Keeps track of historical changes
- System-maintained, no manual updates needed

#### Related Fields

#### POV Status and Details

- Required when a Proof of Value is part of the engagement
- Must be maintained throughout the POV process
- For complete details, see the POV tracking guide

#### Customer Success Plan

- Required for all opportunities \$300k+ Net ARR where an SA is meaningfully engaged
- Must be populated with a link to the plan document
- Plan should be continuously developed and updated throughout the opportunity lifecycle until deal closure
- See Customer Success Plans for more details

#### When to Update Fields

- Update fields as soon as status changes occur
- Don't wait until opportunity closes
- Keep fields current for accurate reporting
- Update through Rattle or directly in Salesforce

#### Relationship with Rattle Activity Logging

While these Salesforce fields must be updated directly in Salesforce, activity tracking (which appears as Tasks in Salesforce) can be logged through Rattle:

- Via Rattle notifications after meetings
- Using the /Rattle <opportunity name> command in Slack
- Through the "Update Opportunity" button in Rattle

For detailed instructions on activity logging through Rattle, see Activity Based Logging Guide.

#### Best Practices

## Field Updates

### Timing

- Update fields in real-time when possible
- Don't backdate unless absolutely necessary
- Keep current even if opportunity is early stage

### Accuracy

- Be precise with dates
- Use clear, concise descriptions
- Maintain consistency across opportunities

### Completeness

- Fill all required fields
- Don't leave fields blank or TBD
- Include relevant context

## Common Scenarios

### Multiple SAs

- Only one Primary SA
- Others tracked through activity logging
- Clear handoff process when changing Primary SA

### Stalled Evaluations

- Mark as stalled after 2 weeks of inactivity
- Update status if evaluation resumes
- Document reason in close details

### Commercial Trials

- Align with trial dates
- Must have SA engagement
- Track through completion

### Updating Closed Opportunities

If opportunity is closed and fields need updating, you can request Sales Operation to make the necessary updates: Please reference the ·Requesting Internal Support· section in the Handbook for additional details.

1. Navigate to the closed opportunity that needs to be updated
2. Click on the ·Request Support· button.
3. Choose "Sales Ops" team from the dropdown list and select Next.
4. Select "Other (SPECIFY IN NOTES)" request type and specify needed updates in the "Notes"

field providing clear justification

Example message:

txt

Please update the SA Validated Tech Evaluation Close Status to Won,  
and SA Validated Tech Evaluation End Date to 2024-01-14

### Validation Rules

- Start Date must be before End Date
- Close Status required if End Date is set
- Close Details required if Status is set
- Primary SA required for Stage 3+ opportunities

### Reporting & Analytics

These fields drive key reports:

- Technical Evaluation Dashboard
- SA Activity Analysis
- Win/Loss Analysis
- Pipeline Health Metrics

### Field Dependencies

Understanding how fields interact:

- Start Date enables End Date
- End Date requires Close Status
- Close Status requires Close Details
- All fields linked to Primary SA

### Quality Assurance

Regular checks for:

- Missing required fields
- Inconsistent dates
- Incomplete close details
- Accurate status updates

### Getting Help

- Contact Sales Support for closed opportunity updates
- Reach out to SA leadership for guidance
- Use salesforce-help Slack channel
- Submit feedback through standard process

---

## SECTION: solutions-architects/sa-manager/\_index.md

View the SA Handbook homepage for additional SA-related handbook pages.

Please refer to SA Manager Operating Rhythm Template for a quick summary.

## Managing the Business

### FY26 Solutions Architecture leading KPIs

To align with the company objectives, SA is targeting POV and SA Validated Tech Evaluation with rates (e.g., technical wins and not necessarily opportunity wins).

1. CSPs created and reviewed with customer on 100% of qualifying opportunities
2. 90% technical win rate for SA Validated Technical Evaluations
3. 90% technical win rate for Proof of Values

To hit these targets, SA leaders should ensure high quality data, inspect progress regularly, drive team accountability, and iterate on our execution. The following reports dashboards and are provided to assist with SA leaders.

### Available Reports and Dashboards

- CQ Hygiene metrics dashboard - contains CSP and CSP review percentages for open opportunities in the CQ.
- CSP Rates Dashboard - Provides CSP creation and reviews against our targets for all qualifying opportunities.
- CSP Exceptions - A list of opportunities with CSP exceptions and the associated reason for the current FY
- POV and SA Tech Eval Dashboard - Provides POV and tech eval win rates against targets, tracking hygiene, and other related information.
- Global Top Deal Review Sheet - Provides details for all opportunities over 100K Net ARR, including SA engagement information. (AMER and EMEA also have their own versions of this sheet)
- SA Feasibility Rating - Operational Dashboard - Provides visibility into the adoption, trends, and other details of feasibility scoring.
- SA Activity Dashboards - Dynamic dashboards for exploring SA activity, account, first touch, and individual performance trends.
- SA Activity Dashboards (Legacy) - Dynamic dashboards for exploring SA activity, opportunity, and individual performance trends.
- Rattle boards are also available to view and edit salesforce data in-grid.

### Activity Review

As part of the regular rhythm of business, it is important to review activities related to Prospect and Customer Engagements. This ensure our data is adequate for driving our KPIs as well as deriving insights to improve our execution.

## Weekly

1. SA Next Steps and Next Step Date: ensure during 1-1s that SAs complete and report on SA Next Steps on an opportunity. Are we on track with our technical strategy.

SA Managers can also add comments (e.g., recognition, pattern matching, assists, questions, and data hygiene coaching) and gain insight from SA on next steps.

1. SA Activity Review: Using the available reports and dashboards, review SA Activity Recordings for main opportunities. Ensure that AEs have not closed, or duplicated opportunities that SAs were recording activities against.

1. Primary SA assignment: For Strategic and Enterprise accounts, review list of Most likely opportunities for the quarter in Clari or SFDC, and ensure Primary Solution Architect Fields are not blank and are accurately assigned, especially as it enters Negotiation Stage. Once it enters Closing Stage it is too late to change the Primary SA assignment for credit.

1. Technical Evaluations Review: For Strategic and Enterprise accounts, review all opportunities in Stage 3 and ensure all Technical Evaluation fields are appropriately entered by team.

1. POV reviews: Review all opportunities in Stage 3 that should have a POV record in SFDC. Ensure SA created one. Ensure that a POV Collaboration Project with Success Criteria is completed and URL is in the POV record in SFDC. If there is a need to fill out a special Google Sheet or otherwise for a POV opportunities, ensure those are completed.

1. Customer Success Plans: Review all opportunities in Stage 4 and over 300k to ensure that the needed elements and content that make it a Customer Success Plan are in place. Enquire of SA during 1-1 if it was reviewed with the Customer, and with the CSM (as needed), and set checkbox as appropriate in SFDC.

1. Value Stream Discovery: Determine opportunities that VSDs have been positioned or started.

1. Review Gong Recordings: Reviewing Gong calls regularly can allow for SA Managers to check in and give managers opportunities to provide timely feedback on technical discovery calls or demos. Considering data sovereignty challenges in certain parts of the world and nations, it may not always be possible to review recorded Gong call, that is for regions such as APAC or EMEA. As a result, the SA Manager should collaborate with cross-functional teams and consider joining internal or external meetings instead. This will ensure adherence to sales plans and strategies as well as assistance in key business opportunities. Additionally, by providing leadership on initiatives and opportunities, the SA Manager can share best practises and approaches with the teams and clients.

1. Regular syncs with ASMs: Meeting regularly with your ASM counterpart provides time to discuss SAE/ SA/ CSM Team health, review strategic territory deals, and review opportunity close analysis and regional data. It is recommended to use a combination of SFDC Opportunity Records, Tableau Dashboard Data, and to take notes in Google Docs. Every meeting should have an agenda.

### Suggested Agenda:

- Discuss SA/SAL/AE Team health
- Review strategic territory deals
- Review opportunity close analysis and regional data

## Monthly

1. Growth and Renewal At Risk Opportunities: Review Growth and renewals at risk for current

quarter and next. Review appropriate action plans.

2. Review escalations: Review all accounts in escalations. Ensure progress is being made

3. Go To Market Reviews: Report on SA initiatives and Progress in GTM review meetings

### Quarterly

1. SA Alignment: Review SA Territory and/or Opportunity mapping alignments. Review Strategic Pools, for High velocity Teams

2. Executive Business Reviews

3. Quarterly Business Reviews

### Executive Business Reviews

Review with CSM Managers or ASM all accounts that have not had an EBR in the last 6 months. Ensure that one is scheduled

It increases efficiencies towards the achievement of regional goals and objectives and helps to refer to upper management on potential issues and challenges. Collaboration with sales management to fully qualify and manage the delivery of solution architecture engagements during technical evaluations on key strategic client opportunities is encouraged.

### Quarterly Business Reviews

The SA Manager is responsible for developing and delivering a Quarterly Business Review for their team each quarter.

SA Managers typically cover the following information:

- Review past quarter
- Assess current quarter
- Review strategic initiatives
- Review sales talent needs
- Review retrospective results

### Managing the Team

#### Operating Rhythm

As a SA manager, the following is a summary of the operating rhythm when managing the team.

#### Weekly

1. SA One on Ones:

2. SA Team Meetings

#### One-on-Ones

As part of reviewing and supporting the team activities, SA Managers should meet with each team member weekly. This is important to build rapport and trust between manager and team member. With this in mind, SA Managers should add topics to the agenda and encourage team members to

contribute to the agenda as well. One-on-Ones can be a great place to check on team member's health and workload, identify needs of individual team members, review top deals, and provide feedback and coaching. One-on-One meetings with direct team members should also follow the GitLab guidance outline here and document discussions.

#### Monthly

1. Review SA Vacation Reports in Workday
2. Review SA Monthly Expenses in Navan

#### Quarterly

1. SA Individual Growth Plan Review: Every Quarter set aside some time apart from one on ones, to review SA's Individual Growth Plans and progress in Workday.
2. Quarterly Sit Downs
3. SA Club Leaderboard and Wildcard Review: Review SA Club Leaderboard in Table and make any adjustments to Wildcard system
4. Team Quarterly Enablements aka Quarterlies: Highly recommended as a region to conduct a team quarterly enablement to conduct deliberate practices, conduct retros, allow for SAs to demonstrate great practices with each other, and invite others such as PS, partners, PMs to speak with the SAs
5. Team Retros
6. Quarterly Deliberate Practice
7. Quarterly cognitive bias training

#### Semi-Annually

1. SA Talent Assessment
2. Team and Skills Assessment

#### Annually

1. Annual Compensation Review

#### Deliberate Practice

Deliberate practice allows the team to sharpen their skills and continue delivering deal-winning engagements. The SA Manager needs to support ongoing role play exercises and dry-runs for key accounts. This includes facilitating sessions, helping the team make this a priority, and ensure the team is adhering to key delivery methodologies, including MEDDPIC and Demo2Win. Important tools include Google Slides, Role Plays, and the picker wheel.

#### Cognitive Bias Sessions

It is important to plan and schedule Cognitive Bias Sessions for the team quarterly. Be sure to think about assigning a facilitator and role players, as needed.

#### Team Assessment

Twice a year, SA Managers should conduct a team assessment to:

- Identify at Risk and High Potential Team Members
- Identify resource needs for the next 6-months
- Determine succession plan
- Update rolling 6 to 12 month promotion forecast

### Quarterly Sit Downs (QSDs)

Given that the role of the Solutions Architect can vary in roles and responsibilities it can be valuable to ensure that there are consistent avenues for continuous feedback throughout the year. The quarterly sit down (QSD) aims to provide feedback in a way that is informal, comprehensive, and provocative. That is to say that the sit downs force both the SA Manager and Solutions Architect to hear the other's perspective and identify misalignment between the manager and individual contributor.

The quarterly sit down (QSD) structure (template) gives both the manager and direct report a chance to independently craft responses on behalf of the direct report and is aligned to the following areas:

- Key Accomplishments within the last quarter
- Review of the previous quarter's goals (relying on last quarter's QSD)
- Top 5 Goals for the next quarter
- Strengths
- Areas to Develop
- What my manager can do to support me

This is to be done on a quarterly basis and aims to bring better alignment and more visibility between the direct report and manager.

Each section is to be used to capture what the Direct Report and the Manager have perceived as the Direct Report's accomplishments, goals, etc. with the intent of sharing these section by section during the QSD. Each area will be read aloud (no screen sharing) which gives the recipient a chance to listen and write down what they hear. Neither is to see the others' sheet until after the meeting is finished. This conversation format helps surface differences in perception or disagreements and opens useful conversations about future priorities or areas of growth.

At the conclusion of the Quarterly Sit Down, it is valuable to review the gaps between each list and then share the document out in a read-only format with each other.

At the next Quarterly Sit Down, it is important to review the goals section from the previous Quarterly Sit Down.

Why the team does QSDs at the end of Q3 during Talent Assessments are taking place

The goal of the Quarterly Sit Down (QSD) is to ensure that two-way goal alignment is taking place every quarter, which is why the QSD takes place every quarter.

At the end of Q3 of each year, individuals are asked to perform their own Talent Assessment for the year. The Talent Assessment is very similar to the QSD format.



Similarly, at the end of Q4, results from the Talent Assessment are shared out from the manager to the direct report.

We do both the QSD at the end of Q3 and Q4 because the Talent Assessment is filled out at the end of Q3 and not made visible to the direct report until the end of Q4. Additionally, the results are a culmination of the entire year, not specific to the quarter.

---

### Identifying and Recruiting

SA Managers should always be recruiting! It is important that SA Managers always be on the lookout for talent and be conscientious in building a talent network. Make time to interview prospective candidates and be able to articulate the value of a job at GitLab as outlined in the Winning Top Talent portion of the GitLab Field Manager Development Program.

### Key Resources

- Success Profile
- Interview Guide
- Networking tools
- "Why GitLab" Summary

### Onboarding

SA Managers should ensure the new SA team members are set up for success by working to make sure they have access to necessary tools and have an assigned onboarding buddy. Additionally, they should work with new SAs to set clear performance expectations and provide regular feedback during the onboarding process. SA Managers should encourage new SAs to complete their general GitLab onboarding issue and ensure that they actively participate in and complete Sales Quick Start.

Common slack channels within GitLab are thanks and deal-gratitude are manual from an announcement and celebration point of view. The wins-key-deals are automated listings and announcements. Those automated slack channels require a SFDC mapping of the team and organisational roll ups. SA Managers are encouraged to review the SFDC mapping on a quarterly basis to ensure consistency for new starters and existing team members (i.e. after promotions).

### Developing and Retaining

Developing and retaining key talent is constantly top-of-mind for high-performing SA Managers. The best SA Managers provide regular coaching, follow Performance Management best practices, and leverage GitLab's Field Functional Competencies to reinforce the critical skills and behaviors that will lead to desired outcomes/results.

Additionally, SA Managers should reinforce key enablement initiatives and encourage participation in the CS Skills Exchange.

SA Managers should encourage and lead team member's proactively to discuss individual development and growth path and always aim to assist team members to grow careers.

## Recognition and Gratitude

As a manager it's extremely important to recognize the accomplishments of your team members. There are studies that show that providing gratitude not only improves the life and mindset of the receiver, but also the one giving the gratitude. As an all-remote company, it's very important that we communicate that gratitude in a timely manner. One thing to keep in mind, however, is that not every team member wants to be recognized the same way. When meeting with your team in One-on-One's ask them how they like to be recognized and keep that in mind for when and how you do it.

GitLab has a dedicated thanks Slack channel where team members are encouraged to provide messages of gratitude for all manner of contributions. As a rule, when recognizing one of your team members, please include the @saleaders Slack group so that every Solutions Architect leader is made aware and is able to comment on the accomplishment. Doing so provides greater visibility into the work done and helps build the brand of the SA. Additional guidelines can be found [here](#)

It may be good practice as well to keep a running log of the accomplishments of your team members (e.g. screenshots from the thanks channel, notes from AEs, ASMs, etc...). An easy way to do this is in a dedicated section of the individual One-on-One documents you keep for each of them or the SA can collect them in their Individual Growth Plan document. Having this information in a consolidated place will assist you greatly come review time or when that team member is ready for promotion.

Recognition can also be realized in the form of Discretionary Bonuses. This is an amazing incentive and benefit that GitLab provides for those team members that are going above and beyond. Once you as a manager receive the nomination in Slack via the Nominator app, make sure you approve or deny based on the Approval Criteria. You will also have an option to update the nomination text at this step. After you approved, there are two more approvals from the 2nd Level Manager and People Team. When your team member is approved for a bonus it is up to you to make the announcement in the thanks Slack channel. Again, when doing so, please ensure you add the @saleaders Slack group as part of the message. As a regular part of your meetings with the ASMs you support, ensure that they and their teams know how to log a discretionary bonus should one be warranted.

---

## SECTION: solutions-architects/sa-manager/sa-offsites.md

### SA Offsites (in-person)

This page provides the SA leadership with guidance when organising a in-person team offsite or gathering. The page outlines considerations prior to the event start date, during the event and follow up considerations.

During the global pandemic (COVID-19) and a fully-remote working sales force at GitLab, in-person team gathering events have proven to be of positive value to GitLab to facilitate more effective communication, help improving stronger team relationships and increase collaborative engagements. This page is meant to be a guide.

## Offsite planning and before the event start

The following list of considerations could be valuable for the SA leaders to go through ahead of engaging further GitLab divisions:

1. Engage with your SA Management to seek pre-approval for a in-person team offsite/gathering

1. Prepare a business justification for your SA Management articulating clearly the team's locations

- Provide reasons for in-person team meetings choice of location
- Start communicating anticipated event arrival, start, end and departure dates

1. Engage with our CS divisional FP&A Analyst in Finance to understand the preferred methods/formats for the budget estimates document - the below section applies to flights, car rentals, mileage calculations or any alternative travel mode:

- US based regions: research domestic flight options for team members and specify estimated costings in the budget in a from/to section per team member

- EMEA / APAC regions: research international travel arrangements and verify with individual team members the appropriate travel arrangements and specify estimated costings in the budget in a from/to section per team member

1. Put together a budget estimates document and submit to Finance for review/approval

- Often when the group books their accommodation in the same hotel as the required meeting venue, a more beneficial group rate can be arranged

- Consider adding breakfasts and lunches during the team offsite as part of the hotel and conference room booking

- Note: Given approval cycles and travel arrangement cost changes due to a future bookings and economic changes - it is recommended to include a 10% surcharge on top of the estimates in the budget

- Consider organising team dinners on-site in the hotel as well as on other days outside of the hotel. It is recommended to work with the hotel event organizer for guidance on suitable restaurants as the hotel can arrange for appropriate transportation as well

1. Once Finance Approval has been obtained - advise the team to start booking initial travel arrangements to secure the most cost-effective travel

## Additional Tips

1. Collaboration within the team is critical when planning the offsite to ensure an enjoyable and inclusive environment for all team members.

1. When planning team building activities, consider that team members interests may vary deeply and ensure everyone's comfort level is paramount (also that no activity is mandatory).

1. Make sure you are aware of all team member's dietary requirements, and coordinate with the hotel / restaurants to ensure there are options available for all needs.

- Ideally, request that team members with dietary requirements look at the menus prior to finalising bookings, to ensure they are satisfied with the options available.

## Venue selection

Once the SA leader(s) has identified a suitable location (city) for the team offsite, it is recommended that you coordinate with the local Field Marketing team to gather their guidance on suitable venues to accommodate the offsite. The Field Marketing team is likely to have the best know-how and local experience, which may invaluable to the SA leadership when organizing an event.

1. Get in touch with the hotel sales / reservation team and articulate the required dates for the offsite
1. Review team member's out-of-office dates and commit to a minimum number of attendees with the sales event organizer
1. Consider to articulate the need for hotel reservations in the same venue, a COVID-19 safe conference room size, meals, internet connectivity, projector setup, etc.
1. Note: Hotel venues often would encourage organisation to consider a team gala cocktail / socialising event in-house, meaning in the hotel.
1. Once an agreement has been found between the SA Offsite organizer and the hotel - submit the terms and conditions via our GitLab official procurement mechanism outlined here - Coupa End Users Guide
  - Step 1: Ensure the supplier is a vendor to GitLab
  - Step 2: Raise a Request and seek contracts reviews and required approvals
  - Step 3: If needed, raise a request for a Virtual Credit Card
  - Step 4: Work with supplier to seek appropriate invoices for PO

#### Additional Tips

- Do not underestimate the value of constantly accessible coffee, tea and water, as well as healthy snacks - coordinating with the event organizer
- Consider the conference rooms carefully - you'll be spending a lot of time in them
  - Does the room have adequate lighting?
  - Does it have natural light?
  - Where are the Restroom facilities (WC, toilets, washrooms) nearby?
  - Temperature controls independent of the rest of the building? (AC (aircon)/Heating)
  - Dedicated smoking area nearby?

#### Weeks leading to event start date

Consider reviewing COVID-19 restrictions and requirements during regular team meetings as well as through asynchronous communication methods.

- US regions: Work within the COVID-19 requirements for domestic travel
- EMEA / APAC regions: Review countries incoming travel requirements as a team and try to understand mandatory pre-arrival PCR or Rapid Antigen Tests needs

1. As the SA leader, ensure appropriate calendar placeholders have been put in place for the team members
  1. Start by communicating with Sales and Channels Management around the offsite dates
  1. Communicate with Sales and Channels Sales team that the team will be unavailable for client and channels meetings during those dates
  1. Collaborate on the team offsite agenda and collaborate with the team - make it interactive
  1. Consider to structure and organise the team offsite in form of gdocs documents, GitLab Wiki pages, Issues or any other collaborative methods
    - APAC example of a Wiki page - FY23 April (internal)
  1. As a SA leader, consider to organize collaborative document for the event to transparently share on arrival and departure dates, flight numbers, end-to-end team members stays and what team building activities would be beneficial during the offsite as it is meant to be fun

#### Offsite Start / Kickoff

As the organizer of the offsite, ensure that the purpose, objectives and vision of the offsite are clearly articulated and covered during the opening / kickoff at day 1.

1. For a smooth start, the SA Leader should consider meeting the event organiser from the hotel at least an hour ahead of the kickoff time on day 1. Ensuring the internet connectivity works, microphones, speakers and projectors are available and working

1. Coordinate with the event organizer to understand morning tea, lunch and afternoon tea breaks and incorporate into the agenda

1. As the SA Leader, consider summarising the objectives, the agenda for the entire offsite, housekeepings overviews, daily breaks in a Powerpoint deck

1. Have fun during the event

### Offsite Completion

On the last day, coordinating with the event organizer to understand that all invoices have been covered and review additional charges.

1. Connect with the procurement team upon your return to your remote based location and ensure that all payment requests have been finalised in Coupa

In the spirit of our company values, it is recommended to transparently share the success the of the Offsite with our SA team worldwide. Offering assistance and ideas for future events and don't forget to share picture via internal communications channels.

---

## SECTION: solutions-architects/sa-practices/\_index.md

### SA Practices

Solution Architects have various practices:

Communities of Practice

Deliberate Practice

Effective Objection Handling

Recognizing Cognitive Bias

Ride Alongs

Value Stream Discovery

SA Office Hours for AE/CSM/SA Collaboration

Solution Architecture Retrospective Feedback

Monthly Release Quiz

SA Subject Matter Expert program

Whiteboard-based Facilitation

SA Practices - Pre-sales

The following practice and process are lead by the Solutions Architects during pre-sales:

Proof of Value

Day In The Life of a Developer

Strategic Solution Selling

GitLab Dedicated Prospects

Selling Professional Services

Mutual Customer Success Plan

Business Value Consulting

---

## SECTION: solutions-architects/sa-practices/business-value-consulting.md

Business Value Services is a practice and approach that allows the GitLab deal team (AEs and SAs as well as the extended team) to:

- Focus on customer challenges and required GitLab DevSecOps capabilities to address these challenges
- Quantify value of the GitLab solution with performance improvements and measurable business outcomes

The practice starts from the first conversation at the discovery and scoping stages. The output of the business value discussion can consist of the Return on Investment (ROI), Total Cost of Ownership (TCO), Cost of Inaction, and other quantified & qualified benefits and outcomes, all of which constitutes the Business Case. This allows the team to:

- Drive value discussion to address challenges, support organizational goals and vision
- Expand the customer reach and engage right stakeholders
- Demonstrate hard cost savings along with validated efficient gains and performance improvements
- Amplify GitLab business values across the customer organization
- Co-build a business value justification as one team between the customer and GitLab
- Derisk the buyers decision with credible, quantifiable justification

Why Business Value Discussion

Derisking a customer's buying decision by incorporating the business value discussion and

exercise into the customer engagement is important. GitLab provides a comprehensive AI-powered DevSecOps platform that provides the software delivery solution with high impacts on business, technology and teams across the organization. Organizations need to make their strategic investment in DevSecOps with demonstrable ROI and path to value realization.

Often times, the business value conversation started with the customers wanting to understand more value proposition and business outcomes. GitLab as the industry leader in DevSecOps can provide referencable customer journey and quantitative measures. SAs can provide the consultative advices to identify transformational drivers for the organizations and help measure the results of DevSecOps transformation as the performance improvement.

#### Utilizing the Business Value Platform to create Business Cases

GitLab's Business Value Platform is a tool integrated into Salesforce that takes GitLab's proprietary ROI modeling and provides a scalable, consistent way for AEs to build business cases and demonstrate ROI in customer conversations. It also allows them to tailor these generated business cases and proposals to their customers as well as to GitLab's value framework and Command of Message methodology. The sales field starts from several ROI model templates and co-builds a strong business case with their customer that allows them to engage around the right value drivers, and communicate the value of GitLab that targets meaningful customer outcomes.

This tool allows us to democratize value-based conversations by creating a self-serve model that balances business value positioning with quantitative analysis. Instead of a centralized team that holds onto this, we are enabling everyone to create, customize, and communicate value to customer organizations in partnership with their customer.

#### Benefits of the Business Value Platform:

- Create a consistent and scalable way to show ROI & quantifiable value as to why a customer should partner with GitLab on their desired business outcomes
- Derisk the buyers decision with credible, quantifiable justification
- Allow sellers to self-serve and create meaningful, personalized business cases that stand out from the competition
- Make it easy for customer champions to co-build & co-sell in and across their business with GitLab
- Track and facilitate meaningful collaboration with our customers on desired and realized outcomes
- Open doors to C-Level conversations with customized business justifications for high-value, complex deals

#### Activities Conducted by the account team

The account team can incorporate the value consulting into early sales stages while building a trusted relationship on both technology leadership and business impacts.

- Discovery stage
  - Identify challenges and opportunities and position GitLab DevSecOps platform
  - Engage with discover questions for the values and benefits
- Scoping stage

- Conduct value stream workshop (VSW) with the customer with identified key stakeholders
- Align the organization vision and initiative to DevSecOps roadmap while building the trusted relationship
- Surface the value drivers in the customer context that can drive the organization transformation. Often times, the top drivers can be tool consolidation for better efficiency and reduced cost, and securing the software supply chain for improved compliance and reduced security risk.

At this time, customers or prospects may request a budgetary proposal along with the value drivers and associated benefits that are quantified as the dollar amount and business hours reclaimed for the performance improvement.

- Technical evaluation
  - Conduct technical evaluation activities including Proof of Value (POV) along with the required capabilities and strategic DevSecOps solution in the customer's context
  - Identify and quantify business values associated with the agreed drivers, mapped to ROI and investment options, provide clear understanding how to measure and realize the benefit realization
- Negotiation
  - Work on the commercial proposal with investment options and TCO by the deal team and led by AE, with measurable positive business outcomes from the proposed solution
  - Incorporate agreed ROI along with the adoption speed, and time to value with the Professional Services

#### Top Value Drivers and Benefits

- Increase Operational Efficiencies - Simplify the software development toolchain to reduce total cost of ownership
  - Top value drivers: Tool consolidation, often this value driver can be mapped to a set of hardcost on tooling license, hosting, infrastructure incurred
- Deliver Better Products Faster - Accelerate the software delivery process to meet business objectives
  - Top value drivers: Automation and performance improvement for software delivery, with quantifiable benefits in either dollar amount and business hours reclaimed for teams focusing on software innovation. Forrester's GitLab Total Economic Impact Reports outlined many measurable benefits with customer case studies to support these soft cost areas.
- Reduce Security and Compliance Risk - Simplify processes to comply with internal processes, controls and industry regulations without compromising speed
  - Top value drivers: Secure the software supply chain, bring application security to developer's hand and mature organizational DevSecOps practice. Both individual tool cost can be calculated to consolidated into a DevSecOps platform along with associated cost on developer velocity when addressing security concerns early in the SDLC.
- Accelerate Cloud Adoption & Transformation - Standardize cloud processes to accelerate business outcomes
  - Top value drivers: Streamline and standardize cloud first practice for DevSecOps and applications to bring products and services to the market faster, safer and more accessible. The benefits of eliminating high on premise infrastructure cost with associated SREs can be realized with managed services by GitLab in the cloud. App development teams, infrastructure teams and security teams can deliver software faster and more securely.

---



## SECTION: solutions-architects/sa-practices/day-in-the-life.md

Every company is developing software. Whether it is external facing applications, or internal applications, or both. Every company wants to be more efficient at developing software, as it has a direct correlation with the company's success. GitLab is positioned to help every company create better applications by providing capabilities throughout the application delivery process including development, operations and security. In the past, there was not one solution to help companies develop software from idea to deployment. Companies relied on purchasing specific products for specific capabilities, and/or used manual methods such as email, spreadsheets, and documents to keep track of their development.

The purpose of the Day In The Life of a Developer is to understand the company's current development process, look for opportunities for improvement, and relay those findings back to our stakeholders. These improvement opportunities can then be communicated back in the form of an executive brief where prescriptive guidance can be shared, providing an explanation of where, how, and at what level of effort may be required as we partner with the customer to make those improvements.

A Day In The Life of a Developer is a demonstration by the company that allows for deeper discovery around how the process currently works and where areas can be improved. The demonstration usually can be done within a 90 minute meeting, with appropriate attendees, and active discussion regarding the process.

## Process

1. Qualify the Opportunity for a Day In The Life of a Developer
1. Educate potential participants and obtain commitment to the workshop
1. Prepare for the Day In The Life of a Developer
1. Initial customer pitch
1. Plan the Day In The Life of a Developer
1. Day In The Life of a Developer Demonstration
1. Executive Briefing - Summarize the findings
1. Contribute back to this framework

## Qualify

Day In The Life of a Developer requires commitment by both the GitLab field teams and our prospects and customers. To ensure the appropriate return on this investment of time, the opportunities should meet the following criteria:

- The account has a total addressable market of at least 100 GitLab users
- The prospect or customer is focused on improving their software delivery performance
- We have a relationship with the economic buyer
- We have identified and established a relationship with the champion
- We suggest pitching a Day In The Life of a Developer prior to a Proof of Value (PoV) to understand bottlenecks and development opportunities important to the company's stakeholders. This also gives us an opportunity to agree upon success criteria for value drivers if a PoV is required for deal closure.

In case a Day In The Life of a Developer is conducted by a customer success manager (CSM), the

following criteria should be met:

- We have identified and established a relationship with the champion
- The account has a total addressable market of at least 100 GitLab users
- The customer has expressed a strong desire to improving their software delivery performance

Key indicators that the opportunity is well-suited include:

- There is a specific initiative to accomplish one or more of the following by a specific date
  - Modernize a specific application or applications
  - Deliver a new critical application to the market
  - Transform or objectively improve their ability to deliver software
  - Modernize their DevOps capabilities
- The customer is currently using some features of GitLab and is interested in how leveraging more of the platform will drive software delivery outcomes
- For customer success, a Day In The Life of a Developer should help uncover opportunities to expand into new use cases or improve current adoption by identifying bottlenecks in the current software delivery process
- An existing customer shows interest in adopting our Day In The Life of a Developer approach to drive software delivery performance

The scope of a Day In The Life of a Developer should always be clearly defined. A clearly defined scope ensures that the correct people are being included in the team and reduces the risk of time lost agreeing what should be focused on. For this reason, the scope of a GitLab facilitated assessment must always be within the DevSecOps space.

### Education and Commitment

A successful Day In The Life of a Developer requires a commitment by the software delivery stakeholders and the personnel experienced with the various processes that constitute their development process. Without understanding the assessment process and its value to their organization, key participants will lack the commitment to ensure a successful Day In The Life of a Developer. Educate the prospect or customer on the benefits, process details, and the required commitment.

While a Day In The Life of a Developer is an advanced discovery workshop, it's expected that initial opportunity discovery and technical discovery have been conducted.

### Key Benefits

- Discovery and documentation of the Day In The Life of a Developer or "path to production" currently in place
  - Establish an agreed upon baseline from which to measure the progress of software delivery performance
  - Identify manual configuration touchpoints and handoffs and other bottlenecks
  - Create a process improvement roadmap
  - Understand the return on investment of a value delivery platform
  - Promote collaboration amongst traditionally siloed functions within the DevSecOps lifecycle

After the prospect or customer understands the process and its benefits, confirm commitment

from the stakeholders and workshop participants by scheduling the facilitated workshop and/or interviews. Estimate the duration of the assessment and set the expectation that the documented software development process, recommendations, and readout will be delivered.

#### What is The Required Time Commitment?

Focusing on the goals and benefits listed above, the time required to complete a minimally viable Day In The Life of a Developer will vary from organization to organization. The workshop should NOT require exhaustive discussion and research. Depending on the availability and commitment of the various participants and stakeholders, the practice will take 90 minutes to two hours for a demonstration and discovery to take place.

#### Prepare

##### Account Team

Prior to the pitch, the account team should:

- Identify executive sponsor, stakeholders and participants
- Identify business objectives
- Identify an application/project for the Day In The Life demo. This is an important step as it focuses the discovery on a single flow where there is a clear beginning and end that has the potential to be measured for delays. The project should reflect a critical or typical development process, spanning idea to deployment, that the business is looking to improve.

##### SA

Usually, through discovery, there is some level of knowledge of customer goals and the current development process from a development perspective. The goal of the Day In The Life is to understand the entire development process from idea to deployment to production, and to look for areas of improvement throughout.

Prepare for the Day In The Life of a Developer, by organizing the information we already have about the customer and identifying areas we want to learn more about. This should include GitLab's goals for the meeting, which should align with the Customer Success Plan.

Prepare questions in advance for the list of things we want to learn. Questions can be drawn from the GitLab Value Framework.

Choose an internal communications medium (ex. Google Doc or Slack) for real-time communication during the workshop. This will help the team with coordinating questions.

#### Pitch

The initial customer pitch, delivered by the SA, allows us to identify key stakeholders & get their buy in. The customer pitch should include:

- What is a Day In The Life of a Developer?
- What does a Day In The Life of a Developer entail?
- Who are the key participants involved in the Day In The Life of a Developer?

- What are some of the expected outcomes of a Day In The Life of a Developer for them?

Here are some resources that can be used as starting point for the pitch:

Customer pitch deck

Internal pitch deck

Planning meeting with customer

Planning a Day In The Life of a Developer can be done within an hour or less, given the right expectation, focus and people involved. Below are aspects to be considered when planning the Day In The Life of a Developer.

Define a Day In The Life Of A Developer

- Who are the members of the team involved in developing an application?
- What application will be demonstrated to highlight development from idea to deployment?
- What context or conditions are being considered?
- What triggering event initiates the work flowing through the development process?

Day In The Life of a Developer Demonstration

- People
- Process
- Tools
- Workflows
- Questions

People

In order to help facilitate a Day In The Life of a Developer, a number of GitLab team members will be required to take part. The roles of these members generally fall into the following:

- Facilitator - A team member fully versed in the software development process who is responsible for leading the session; ensuring that discussion is staying on-topic, at the right level and at the required pace.
- Account Leader - The account leader's responsibility is to ensure that the long term strategic vision for the customer/prospect is considered when discussing desired future state and they can also provide additional context to the current state.
- Scribe - A team member who's primary purpose is to document the session, capture key metrics as they emerge which will later be used to create a current state schematic diagram.

Process

The process which we will go through, at a high level, is as follows:

1. Why we are here? (champion led)
1. Re-iterate expectations set in the planning meeting
  1. Start and end points for the Day In The Life of a Developer
1. Current state
  1. Initial process "walk-through" for the prospect or customer to demonstrate - A best

practice is to share a current state diagram based on our (possibly limited) understanding of the customer's environment to facilitate the Day in the Life discussion

1. Capture people, processes and technology
1. Analyze and identify bottlenecks and improvement areas.
  1. Time is limited - Use the list of discovery questions selected during prep and focus/"double click" on the areas where GitLab can help - avoid delving deep into areas that GitLab cannot affect
1. Design future state
  1. Review the expectations, to align the team on the target they are aiming to create
  1. Determine "right work" (which processes and steps are required for the future state to be optimal)
    1. Remove processes and process steps when they are truly unnecessary
    1. Add processes and process steps when they can optimize overall process time and lead time
  1. Creating an optimized work flow
    1. Aim to reduce the lead time (LT), process time (PT) and achieve a higher percent complete and accurate (%C&A) for every process block where possible
    1. Utilize and leverage GitLab capabilities to improve the development process where applicable
    1. Use Lean countermeasures and improvement tools
  1. Ask the customer to prioritize what we've learned and ask if there's anything we've missed
1. Develop transformation plan (likely completed async)
  1. At the end of the Day In The Life session, be ready to provide a date for the review of the draft output but avoid committing to a date for the final readout. Honoring timelines is important to maintain momentum in the opportunity and for the credibility of our champion. In some cases, feedback received from the customer has led to a complete rethink of the readout which can take longer than originally planned.
  1. Create a day In The Life Readout to present to the customer. The readout will include a review of their current development process and suggestions for how their process can be improved.
  1. For each process block transformation, capture the measurable target, proposed countermeasures, execution method, owner and timeline (later, status as well)

## Tools

- Remote:
  - Zoom, MS Teams, or Google Meet
  - Diagramming tools
  - FigJam or LucidChart for Current State and Future State visualization
    - FigJam is not yet connected to Okta. Login using your Google account. Make sure you have a Full FigJam license with read-write access. (if you're in read-only mode, you need to request a full license)
    - LucidChart is an IT-managed application. If you are unsure if you have LucidChart access, go to the Okta interface in your browser, then select "Search Your Apps" and see if LucidChart SSO is available. If yes, LucidChart has been assigned to you and you can launch it from Okta and collaborate on any LucidChart Documents your team has shared with you. If no, then LucidChart SSO has not been assigned to you yet.
    - If you do not have LucidChart SSO assigned to you in Okta, please navigate to the "access-requests" Project and submit an Issue requesting "Lucid Chart". Assign the Issue to

your Manager and add the IT::to do label. See example Access Request Issue.

- If your Access Request is urgent, paste the link to your Access Request Issue into the ithelp Slack channel and @ mention it-help with a note on why it is urgent.

- Onsite:

- Stickies
- Pens
- Large whiteboard

## Example Workflows

1. Idea to Production

1. Response to Production Incident

1. Toolchain Upgrading and Maintenance

### Idea to Production

### Response to Production Incident

### Toolchain Upgrading and Maintenance

### Executive Briefing - Summarize the Findings

The final meeting as part of the Day in the Life of a Developer process is the findings and next steps presentation (though it's called an executive presentation, it's expected to be a two-way discussion). The high level topics of this meeting are:

1. Summary of planning outcomes; what process was to be mapped and what target goals were created
1. Summary of the current state mapping
1. Summary of the proposed future state mapping
1. Highlight the key differences, expected process and business benefits
1. Walkthrough of recommendations
1. Walkthrough and gain agreement for the transformation plan. The transformation plan should be built in conjunction with professional services to yield best results. Please read how to position professional services in an opportunity here
1. Define next steps and suggest a review date

Example template of the executive briefing can be found here. Please modify accordingly to suit your customer's need.

It is recommended to review the executive briefing with your champion, key stakeholder before the final meeting to collect additional feedback. The goal is to then deliver it jointly to the broader team to gain agreement.

## FAQs from customers/prospects

### 1. What's in it for me - the customer?

- Free, hands-on consultative analysis of their software delivery lifecycle, including their current state, future state, and areas of improvements.
- Competitive analysis of where they are compared to their peers in the industry. This report contains the most recent benchmark values for the four DORA metrics (widely regarded as good measures of DevOps performance) State of DevOps Report 2021.
- Recommendations on how to overcome visible or invisible challenges with a strategic plan to help them reach their future state.

### 1. What are typical outcomes for a customer?

- TBD

### 1. Which teams are typically involved?

- We start with application development team, quality engineering team, application security, then operations.

### 1. What's the best place to start?

- Pick the most business critical application or a representative application that has faster time to market requirement.

### 1. That's a lot of time investment from our teams Or Our teams are busy with other projects.

- It takes approximately 1.5 hrs demonstration to do a focused discovery for a Day In The Life Of A Developer.

## Training and Enablement

<!-- A Day in the Life of a Developer

TBD -->

## How to Contribute

In the spirit of collaboration and iteration, please help to continuously improve this framework. Ways to contribute include:

- Create a merge request to improve this page
- Share your experiences in the customer-success and solutions-architects slack channels
- Provide feedback and/or updates to the pitch deck or provide links to your own variations
- Provide links to your facilitation recordings, summary documentation, and/or other artifacts to this page
- Collaborate in the value-stream-discovery slack channel

---

## SECTION: solutions-architects/sa-practices/deliberate-practice.md

They say that practice makes perfect. While it's true that practice is important to hone one's skills, it's how you actually do that practice that matters. Deliberate Practice is a particular way of practicing that is persistent and intense. When one practices deliberately, they are stretching beyond their normal comfort level and they are focusing on a particular piece of their routine or demonstration to work on with a specific goal of improving

performance.

Similar to athletes breaking down specific parts of their movements, Solutions Architects should be focusing on specific parts of their demonstrations to improve them. As opposed to working on the entire swing all at once, a baseball or cricket player may work on how their hips are positioned or where their hands are on the bat during each swing. Breaking down your routine into areas you can focus on is an important part of practicing deliberately.

Deliberate Practice is not an easy thing to do. It requires you to get out of your comfort level and try new ways to improve. If you keep practicing the same way over and over, you'll never improve.

Once you have broken down your routine and feel good about what you are doing, it's important to solicit feedback on your performance. Feedback is how we grow and learn. Feedback, both receiving and giving, is extremely important in deliberate practice. If you have a new way of attempting something, it's extremely important to contact your team members and perform it for them. Let them see what you've done and offer you feedback. If you are asked to provide feedback, please take it seriously. Feedback of "that looks great!" or "nice job" is friendly, but not the most useful. Try to find specific things the presenter did that stood out or could be improved.

### Techniques That Can Help

Breaking down a demonstration into manageable areas may not be the easiest thing to do, so here are some exercises that GitLab Solution Architects can work on:

#### Lightning Talks

Finding a topic that you are unfamiliar with and putting some time into understanding it can be a great way to improve. A Lightning Talk is a way of delivering this information in a clear and concise manner. Lightning Talks should be no more than five minutes long and should only use slides to get your point across. When performing a Lightning Talk, there should be no need to go into the actual application to show what you are discussing. Use the minimal slides you have to get quickly to your point and explain how it can be beneficial to GitLab users. Five minutes goes very fast when addressing a group or performing a discussion. Lightning Talks can also help you prepare for how best to deliver your message. If you only have so much time, you want to make sure the words you use are the meaningful ones that get your point across.

GitLab Solutions Architects should feel comfortable performing Lightning Talks in front of their peers

#### Tips:

- Give a quick intro to who you are and why you are discussing this topic today
- A five minute Lightning Talk should have 10 slides at the most
- Set a scenario, but get to your point quickly
- Do not try to cover more than one topic in Lightning Talk
- Begin your wrap-up with about one minute remaining so you can recap
- Solicit feedback from your peers and/or manager



Examples:

- SAST for Helm Charts
- Open Source MR Process
- Parallel Matrix in GitLab CI

#### Demo Jam

Similar to lightning talks, Demo Jam is practiced amongst the Commercial SA Team as a safe place to continuously practice showcasing features, managing objections, and improving storytelling.

#### Objection Handling Workshops

To ensure that GitLab Solution Architects are as best prepared as they can be, the practice of Objection Handling is something we would love all SA's to be well versed in. The SA Handbook has an entire page devoted to effective Objection Handling.

#### Feature Fridays

This is a fun practice where a Solutions Architect Manager will select up to 3 SA's to pick an interesting feature they like most and have them do a quick Slack message about it. As the name implies, the SA should post these on Friday mornings. Selections should be done on a Wednesday so the SA's have time to think about it and put together a simple summary. SA's can post the message in the customer-success Slack channel. These should be pretty minimal, but at the very least, the summary should include the name of the feature, why they like it and a link to the documentation. If there's a project that shows off this feature, SA's can feel free to include that as well.

- Example:

"I'm a huge fan of our DAST scanning. Being able to scan a working application from the outside provides customers with tons of value. Customers can see if there are any vulnerabilities before ever deploying to production. In our 13.3 release, users can even scan On-Demand!"

#### Discovery Facilitation Practice

This is a facilitation session where Solutions Architects will be assigned a random discovery scenario with a stakeholder. They will have 20 mins to do discovery & achieve the end outcome. Other attendees will provide feedback using the facilitation feedback rubric. The selected SAs will have a week of lead time to prepare for the discovery session.

- Example:

Enterprise US Solutions Architecture Deliberate Practice

#### Peer Reviews

An SA peer review involves a collaborative exchange among members of the same SA team regarding ongoing opportunities. The primary SA and other team members engage in discussions aimed at

enhancing teamwork and achieving improved outcomes. This entails sharing insights, best practices, and strategies for closing opportunities more effectively and efficiently. It provides a supportive environment for evaluating opportunities in progress, drawing lessons from colleagues' experiences, and exchanging valuable insights through questions and suggestions.

The benefits of frequent peer review sessions include:

1. Quality Enhancement: Peer review sessions help identify potential issues, errors, or gaps in pre-sales collateral materials and processes, ensuring that the value proposition and technical opportunity plans are of the highest quality before they reach the customer.
1. Diverse Perspectives: Different team members bring unique viewpoints and expertise to the table. Peer reviews encourage the sharing of diverse perspectives, leading to well-rounded and comprehensive pre-sales strategies.
1. Knowledge Sharing: Peer reviews facilitate the sharing of knowledge, best practices, and lessons learned. Team members can learn from each other's experiences, contributing to continuous improvement.
1. Improved Accuracy: Through rigorous examination, peer review sessions can help catch inaccuracies, inconsistencies, or misinterpretations in information shared with customers.
1. Enhanced Collaboration: Collaborative peer reviews foster teamwork and open communication among team members. They encourage open discussions, idea sharing, and joint problem-solving, leading to stronger collaboration within the pre-sales team.
1. Efficiency: Catching mistakes early in the pre-sales process prevents time-consuming and costly corrections later. Peer reviews streamline the process by addressing issues promptly, resulting in more efficient workflows.
1. Client-Centric Approach: Peer reviews help ensure that the technical opportunity plans are tailored to the client's needs and preferences. This client-centric approach increases the likelihood of delivering a compelling and relevant value proposition.
1. Skill Development: Participating in peer review sessions hones team members' analytical and critical thinking skills. Constructive feedback and discussions contribute to professional growth and development.
1. Confidence Boost: Knowing that the approach and the action plan have undergone rigorous peer review instills confidence in the team's work and gives them assurance when presenting to prospects and customers.

## Process

- Process DRI (rotated monthly or quarterly )
  - Ensures that every session has one or multiple volunteers to present an opportunity for review. If no volunteers are identified, the process DRI is responsible for cancelling the meeting
  - Sends a reminder to team members BEFORE the meeting to ensure they review what has been filled in
- Presenting SA
  - Creates a copy and fills out the SA Peer Review template document before the session. This should not be a heavy lift preparation and the presenting SA is expected to spend max. 10-15 minutes on this. The document should include:
    - High level description of the account and opportunity;
    - Technical Opportunity Plan; Timeline; Actions already executed or planned;
    - Links to additional information (SFDC, slide decks, opportunity / strategy / success

plans, etc.)

- Attending SAs

- Review meeting notes / template beforehand
- Ask questions & provide suggestions during the session. E.g.:
  - Did you consider suggesting Scan Result Policies?
  - Your running notes have great info about the tech stack, how were you able to find that?

### Choosing the right opportunity

A good opportunity for a peer review process should meet following requirements:

- Any ongoing opportunity that would benefit from peers input
- Accounts with growth potential
- Technical discovery has already been completed
- Requires diverse perspective or ideas to unblock the deal

---

## SECTION: solutions-architects/sa-practices/effective-objection-handling-practice.md

Effective Objection handling skill is critical to becoming a trusted advisor in our respective sales/customer success roles. Objection handling means responding to the customer in a way that changes their mind or alleviate their concerns. Objections typically fall into these categories.

### Objection Handling Process

The Objection Handling Process can be broken down into the following steps:

- Listen
  - Active listening is a key part of effective objection handling. Use methods like nodding and physically showing interest.
  - This is our chance to do more discovery & learn as much as about the customer as possible.
- Question
  - Ask questions if it makes sense, generally we find open ended questions are the best way to retrieve information. This not only shows you are interested in them, but it also gives you more information with which to make the sale.
  - As you question them, watch carefully for body language that gives you more information about what they are thinking and feeling.
  - You might also use the "tip the bucket technique" to see if there are more objections that can be answered.
- Think
  - Take a pause to think & figure out which technique is the best for their objection. You will see that these techniques will become second nature with practice.
- Handle
  - Handle the objection in an appropriate time frame using the techniques above or however way you like.
  - You are under no obligation to try and force-fit a method where it is unlikely to work.
- Check
  - Finally, check to find out whether your objection-handling worked! Ask if you have answered

their question. Ask if there are any more concerns. As necessary, handle outstanding objections.

Then go for the close using any of these closing techniques.

#### Objection Handling Techniques That Can Help

The techniques listed below are commonly used in the field to handle objections effectively. Sometimes, we might have to use more than 1 technique to handle an objection. Please remember to use empathy, establish yourself as trusted advisor & use sentences like "let me get back to you on it" when you are not sure on how to handle the objection instantly.

LACE: LACE is a 4 step objection handling technique which is b